

Time Series — Solutions

Practice Exam — Week 12: Non-Linear Time Series — ARCH & GARCH

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Problem 1 (5 points)

Statement.

(ARCH(2): conditional vs. unconditional moments and stationarity.) Let $\{r_t\}$ follow an ARCH(2) model

$$r_t = \sigma_t \eta_t, \quad \sigma_t^2 = \beta_0 + \beta_1 r_{t-1}^2 + \beta_2 r_{t-2}^2,$$

with $\beta_0 > 0$, $\beta_1, \beta_2 \geq 0$, where $\{\eta_t\}$ is a white noise of mean 0 and unit variance, independent of $\mathcal{F}_{t-1}$ (the information up to time $t-1$). Here σ_t is $\mathcal{F}_{t-1}$ -measurable. Take the numerical values $\beta_0 = 0.2$, $\beta_1 = 0.3$, $\beta_2 = 0.5$.

(a) Using the law of iterated expectation (condition on $\mathcal{F}_{t-1}$), show that $\mathbb{E}[r_t | \mathcal{F}_{t-1}] = 0$ and deduce $\mathbb{E}[r_t] = 0$. State also the conditional variance $\text{Var}(r_t | \mathcal{F}_{t-1})$. (1.5 pts)

(b) Assuming $\{r_t\}$ is (weakly) stationary, use the law of total variance to derive the marginal variance $\text{Var}(r_t)$ as a function of $\beta_0, \beta_1, \beta_2$, naming every probability law you use. Then give its numerical value for the parameters above. (2 pts)

(c) State the necessary condition on β_1, β_2 for a (positive, finite) stationary variance to exist, check it for the given numbers, and explain in one sentence why this is the $p = 2$, $q = 0$ instance of the general $\sum_j \alpha_j + \sum_j \beta_j < 1$ rule. (1.5 pts)

Solution.

(a) Since σ_t is $\mathcal{F}_{t-1}$ -measurable and η_t is independent of $\mathcal{F}_{t-1}$ with $\mathbb{E}[\eta_t] = 0$,

$$\mathbb{E}[r_t | \mathcal{F}_{t-1}] = \mathbb{E}[\sigma_t \eta_t | \mathcal{F}_{t-1}] = \sigma_t \mathbb{E}[\eta_t] = \sigma_t \cdot 0 = 0.$$

By the law of iterated (tower) expectation,

$$\mathbb{E}[r_t] = \mathbb{E}[\mathbb{E}[r_t | \mathcal{F}_{t-1}]] = \mathbb{E}[0] = 0.$$

The conditional variance is, since $\mathbb{E}[r_t | \mathcal{F}_{t-1}] = 0$ and $\text{Var}(\eta_t) = 1$,

$$\text{Var}(r_t | \mathcal{F}_{t-1}) = \mathbb{E}[r_t^2 | \mathcal{F}_{t-1}] = \sigma_t^2 \mathbb{E}[\eta_t^2 | \mathcal{F}_{t-1}] = \sigma_t^2 = \beta_0 + \beta_1 r_{t-1}^2 + \beta_2 r_{t-2}^2.$$

(b) By the law of total variance,

$$\text{Var}(r_t) = \mathbb{E}[\text{Var}(r_t | \mathcal{F}_{t-1})] + \text{Var}(\mathbb{E}[r_t | \mathcal{F}_{t-1}]) = \mathbb{E}[\sigma_t^2] + \text{Var}(0) = \mathbb{E}[\sigma_t^2].$$

Taking the (unconditional) expectation of the variance recursion and using *linearity of expectation*,

$$\mathbb{E}[\sigma_t^2] = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \mathbb{E}[r_{t-1}^2] + \beta_2 \mathbb{E}[r_{t-2}^2].$$

Because $\mathbb{E}[r_{t-j}] = 0$ we have $\mathbb{E}[r_{t-j}^2] = \text{Var}(r_{t-j})$, and by *stationarity* $\text{Var}(r_t) = \text{Var}(r_{t-1}) = \text{Var}(r_{t-2}) =: v$. Hence

$$v = \beta_0 + \beta_1 v + \beta_2 v \implies (1 - \beta_1 - \beta_2) v = \beta_0 \implies \boxed{\text{Var}(r_t) = \frac{\beta_0}{1 - \beta_1 - \beta_2}} \quad (\beta_1 + \beta_2 < 1).$$

Numerically, with $\beta_0 = 0.2$, $\beta_1 = 0.3$, $\beta_2 = 0.5$:

$$\text{Var}(r_t) = \frac{0.2}{1 - 0.3 - 0.5} = \frac{0.2}{0.2} = 1.$$

(c) For the variance to be positive and finite we need the denominator positive, i.e.

$$\boxed{\beta_1 + \beta_2 < 1} \quad (\text{with } \beta_0 > 0, \beta_1, \beta_2 \geq 0).$$

Here $\beta_1 + \beta_2 = 0.3 + 0.5 = 0.8 < 1$, so a stationary variance exists (and equals 1). This is exactly the $p = 2, q = 0$ case of the general GARCH stationarity rule $\sum_j \alpha_j + \sum_j \beta_j < 1$: an ARCH(2) has α -coefficients β_1, β_2 and no GARCH (β_j) feedback terms, so the rule reads $\beta_1 + \beta_2 < 1$.

Problem 2 (5 points)

Statement.

(GARCH is mean-zero white noise; stationarity & long-run variance.) A GARCH(m, r) process is

$$r_t = \sigma_t \eta_t, \quad \sigma_t^2 = \alpha_0 + \sum_{j=1}^m \alpha_j r_{t-j}^2 + \sum_{j=1}^r \beta_j \sigma_{t-j}^2,$$

with $\alpha_0 > 0, \alpha_j, \beta_j \geq 0$, and $\{\eta_t\}$ white noise of mean 0 and unit variance, independent of $\mathcal{F}_{t-1}$; σ_t is $\mathcal{F}_{t-1}$ -measurable.

(a) Prove that $\mathbb{E}[r_t] = 0$ and that, for every lag $\tau \neq 0$, $\text{Cov}(r_{t+\tau}, r_t) = 0$, hence $\text{Corr}(r_{t+\tau}, r_t) = 0$. (Hint: for $\tau > 0$ condition on $\mathcal{F}_{t+\tau-1}$ and pull out the measurable factors $r_t, \sigma_{t+\tau}$.) Conclude that $\{r_t\}$ is white noise. (2.5 pts)

(b) For a stationary GARCH, derive the unconditional variance $\text{Var}(r_t) = \alpha_0 / (1 - \sum_j \alpha_j - \sum_j \beta_j)$ by taking unconditional expectations of the σ_t^2 recursion. State the resulting weak-stationarity condition. (You may use $\mathbb{E}[r_{t-j}^2] = \mathbb{E}[\sigma_{t-j}^2] = \text{Var}(r_t)$ at stationarity; justify this identity briefly.) (1.5 pts)

(c) A GARCH(1,1) is fitted to daily log-returns with $\alpha_0 = 2 \times 10^{-5}$, $\alpha_1 = 0.10$, $\beta_1 = 0.85$. Verify weak stationarity, compute the unconditional variance and the implied daily volatility $\sqrt{\text{Var}(r_t)}$, and comment in one sentence on the persistence $\alpha_1 + \beta_1$. (1 pt)

Solution.

(a) Zero mean. σ_t is determined by the past, hence $\mathcal{F}_{t-1}$ -measurable, and η_t is independent of $\mathcal{F}_{t-1}$ with $\mathbb{E}[\eta_t] = 0$. By the tower property,

$$\mathbb{E}[r_t] = \mathbb{E}[\mathbb{E}[r_t | \mathcal{F}_{t-1}]] = \mathbb{E}[\sigma_t \mathbb{E}[\eta_t | \mathcal{F}_{t-1}]] = \mathbb{E}[\sigma_t \cdot 0] = 0.$$

Uncorrelated. Fix $\tau > 0$. Since $\mathbb{E}[r_t] = 0$, $\text{Cov}(r_{t+\tau}, r_t) = \mathbb{E}[r_{t+\tau} r_t]$. Both r_t and $\sigma_{t+\tau}$ are $\mathcal{F}_{t+\tau-1}$ -measurable (they depend only on information up to time $t + \tau - 1$), so conditioning on $\mathcal{F}_{t+\tau-1}$ and pulling them out of the inner expectation,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[r_{t+\tau} r_t] &= \mathbb{E}[\mathbb{E}[\sigma_{t+\tau} \eta_{t+\tau} r_t | \mathcal{F}_{t+\tau-1}]] \\ &= \mathbb{E}[r_t \sigma_{t+\tau} \mathbb{E}[\eta_{t+\tau} | \mathcal{F}_{t+\tau-1}]] = \mathbb{E}[r_t \sigma_{t+\tau} \cdot 0] = 0, \end{aligned}$$

using $\mathbb{E}[\eta_{t+\tau} | \mathcal{F}_{t+\tau-1}] = \mathbb{E}[\eta_{t+\tau}] = 0$ by independence. By symmetry of the covariance the same holds for $\tau < 0$. Therefore $\text{Cov}(r_{t+\tau}, r_t) = 0$ and $\text{Corr}(r_{t+\tau}, r_t) = 0$ for all $\tau \neq 0$. Combined with $\mathbb{E}[r_t] = 0$ and a constant (stationary) variance, $\{r_t\}$ is **white noise**.

(b) As in Problem 1, $\mathbb{E}[r_{t-j}^2] = \text{Var}(r_{t-j})$ (mean zero) and, using $\mathbb{E}[r_{t-j}^2 | \mathcal{F}_{t-j-1}] = \sigma_{t-j}^2$ together with the tower property, $\mathbb{E}[r_{t-j}^2] = \mathbb{E}[\sigma_{t-j}^2]$; by stationarity all these equal $v := \text{Var}(r_t)$. Taking unconditional expectations of the recursion,

$$\mathbb{E}[\sigma_t^2] = \alpha_0 + \sum_{j=1}^m \alpha_j \mathbb{E}[r_{t-j}^2] + \sum_{j=1}^r \beta_j \mathbb{E}[\sigma_{t-j}^2] \implies v = \alpha_0 + \left(\sum_j \alpha_j + \sum_j \beta_j \right) v.$$

Solving,

$$\boxed{\text{Var}(r_t) = v = \frac{\alpha_0}{1 - \sum_j \alpha_j - \sum_j \beta_j}},$$

which is positive and finite **iff**

$$\boxed{\sum_{j=1}^m \alpha_j + \sum_{j=1}^r \beta_j < 1} \quad (\text{the weak-stationarity condition}).$$

(c) For GARCH(1,1) with $\alpha_0 = 2 \times 10^{-5}$, $\alpha_1 = 0.10$, $\beta_1 = 0.85$:

$$\alpha_1 + \beta_1 = 0.10 + 0.85 = 0.95 < 1,$$

so the process is weakly stationary. Then

$$\text{Var}(r_t) = \frac{\alpha_0}{1 - \alpha_1 - \beta_1} = \frac{2 \times 10^{-5}}{1 - 0.95} = \frac{2 \times 10^{-5}}{0.05} = 4 \times 10^{-4},$$

and the implied daily volatility is

$$\sqrt{\text{Var}(r_t)} = \sqrt{4 \times 10^{-4}} = 2 \times 10^{-2} = 2\% \text{ per day},$$

a realistic equity figure. The persistence $\alpha_1 + \beta_1 = 0.95$ is close to 1, the hallmark of financial GARCH fits: volatility shocks decay only slowly (sticky volatility, long quiet/turbulent regimes), yet the process stays stationary because the sum is still strictly below 1.

Problem 3 (5 points)

Statement.

(ARCH(1): kurtosis, the ACF of the squares, and a volatility forecast.) Let $\{r_t\}$ be a stationary ARCH(1),

$$r_t = \sigma_t \eta_t, \quad \sigma_t^2 = \alpha_0 + \alpha_1 r_{t-1}^2,$$

with $\alpha_0 > 0$, $0 < \alpha_1 < 1$, and Gaussian innovations $\eta_t \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 1)$ independent of $\mathcal{F}_{t-1}$. Recall $\mathbb{E}[r_t] = 0$ and $\text{Var}(r_t) = \alpha_0/(1 - \alpha_1)$. You may use $\mathbb{E}[\eta_t^4] = 3$.

(a) Prove that for $\tau > 0$,

$$\text{Cov}(r_{t+\tau}^2, r_t^2) = \alpha_1 \text{Cov}(r_{t+\tau-1}^2, r_t^2),$$

by conditioning on $\mathcal{F}_{t+\tau-1}$ and using $\mathbb{E}[\eta^2 | \mathcal{F}_{t+\tau-1}] = 1$; be sure to show the constant terms cancel using $\mathbb{E}[r_t^2] = \alpha_0/(1 - \alpha_1)$. Deduce that, provided $0 < \alpha_1 < 1/\sqrt{3}$, $\text{Corr}(r_{t+\tau}^2, r_t^2) = \alpha_1^{|\tau|}$. (2.5 pts)

(b) The kurtosis of an ARCH(1) is $\kappa = \frac{3(1 - \alpha_1^2)}{1 - 3\alpha_1^2}$ (valid when $\alpha_1^2 < 1/3$). An estimated model has $\alpha_1 = 0.5$. Compute κ , comment on the tails versus the normal, and report $\text{Corr}(r_{t+\tau}^2, r_t^2)$ at lags $\tau = 1, 2, 3$. Why does the constraint for a finite fourth moment ($\alpha_1^2 < 1/3$) differ from the one for a finite variance ($\alpha_1 < 1$)? (1.5 pts)

(c) For the same model take $\alpha_0 = 4 \times 10^{-4}$ and $\alpha_1 = 0.5$, and suppose the latest observed return is $r_t = 0.04$. Give the one-step-ahead conditional variance σ_{t+1}^2 and a 95% predictive interval for r_{t+1} under Gaussian innovations; compare its width with the unconditional $\pm 1.96 \sqrt{\text{Var}(r_t)}$ band and interpret. (1 pt)

Solution.

(a) Fix $\tau > 0$ and start from the covariance, using stationarity ($\mathbb{E}[r_{t+\tau}^2] = \mathbb{E}[r_t^2]$):

$$\text{Cov}(r_{t+\tau}^2, r_t^2) = \mathbb{E}[r_{t+\tau}^2 r_t^2] - (\mathbb{E}[r_t^2])^2.$$

Condition on $\mathcal{F}_{t+\tau-1}$: both r_t^2 and $\sigma_{t+\tau}^2 = \alpha_0 + \alpha_1 r_{t+\tau-1}^2$ are measurable there, and $\mathbb{E}[\eta_{t+\tau}^2 | \mathcal{F}_{t+\tau-1}] = \mathbb{E}[\eta_{t+\tau}^2] = 1$, so

$$\mathbb{E}[r_{t+\tau}^2 r_t^2 | \mathcal{F}_{t+\tau-1}] = r_t^2 \sigma_{t+\tau}^2 \mathbb{E}[\eta_{t+\tau}^2 | \mathcal{F}_{t+\tau-1}] = r_t^2 (\alpha_0 + \alpha_1 r_{t+\tau-1}^2).$$

Taking expectations,

$$\mathbb{E}[r_{t+\tau}^2 r_t^2] = \alpha_0 \mathbb{E}[r_t^2] + \alpha_1 \mathbb{E}[r_{t+\tau-1}^2 r_t^2].$$

Write $C_\tau := \text{Cov}(r_{t+\tau}^2, r_t^2)$ and use $\mathbb{E}[r_{t+\tau-1}^2 r_t^2] = C_{\tau-1} + (\mathbb{E}[r_t^2])^2$ (again by stationarity, $\mathbb{E}[r_{t+\tau-1}^2] = \mathbb{E}[r_t^2]$). Then

$$C_\tau + (\mathbb{E}[r_t^2])^2 = \alpha_0 \mathbb{E}[r_t^2] + \alpha_1 (C_{\tau-1} + (\mathbb{E}[r_t^2])^2),$$

i.e.

$$C_\tau = \alpha_1 C_{\tau-1} + \underbrace{\alpha_0 \mathbb{E}[r_t^2] + \alpha_1 (\mathbb{E}[r_t^2])^2 - (\mathbb{E}[r_t^2])^2}_{=: R}.$$

Substitute $\mathbb{E}[r_t^2] = \text{Var}(r_t) = \alpha_0/(1 - \alpha_1)$:

$$R = \alpha_0 \cdot \frac{\alpha_0}{1 - \alpha_1} - (1 - \alpha_1) \left(\frac{\alpha_0}{1 - \alpha_1} \right)^2 = \frac{\alpha_0^2}{1 - \alpha_1} - \frac{\alpha_0^2}{1 - \alpha_1} = 0.$$

Hence

$$\boxed{C_\tau = \alpha_1 C_{\tau-1}} \quad (\tau > 0).$$

Iterating τ times from $C_0 = \text{Var}(r_t^2)$ gives $C_\tau = \alpha_1^\tau \text{Var}(r_t^2)$, so

$$\text{Corr}(r_{t+\tau}^2, r_t^2) = \frac{C_\tau}{\text{Var}(r_t^2)} = \alpha_1^\tau,$$

and by symmetry of the autocovariance, $\text{Corr}(r_{t+\tau}^2, r_t^2) = \alpha_1^{|\tau|}$ for all τ . (The condition $0 < \alpha_1 < 1/\sqrt{3}$, i.e. $\alpha_1^2 < 1/3$, guarantees $\text{Var}(r_t^2) = \mathbb{E}[r_t^4] - (\mathbb{E}[r_t^2])^2 < \infty$, so the correlation is well defined.)

(b) With $\alpha_1 = 0.5$, $\alpha_1^2 = 0.25 < 1/3$, so the fourth moment exists and

$$\kappa = \frac{3(1 - \alpha_1^2)}{1 - 3\alpha_1^2} = \frac{3(1 - 0.25)}{1 - 0.75} = \frac{3 \cdot 0.75}{0.25} = \frac{2.25}{0.25} = 9.$$

Since $\kappa = 9 > 3$, the marginal law has *heavier tails than the normal* (excess kurtosis $9 - 3 = 6$): ARCH generates fat tails endogenously, even with Gaussian innovations. The squared-return autocorrelations are $\text{Corr}(r_{t+\tau}^2, r_t^2) = 0.5^{|\tau|}$:

$$\tau = 1 : 0.5, \quad \tau = 2 : 0.25, \quad \tau = 3 : 0.125.$$

The two thresholds differ because they control different moments: $\alpha_1 < 1$ keeps the *second* moment ($\text{Var } r_t = \alpha_0/(1 - \alpha_1)$) finite, whereas the *fourth* moment involves $\mathbb{E}[\sigma_t^4]$ and the recursion for it carries the factor $3\alpha_1^2$ (from $\mathbb{E}[\eta^4] = 3$); a finite solution needs $3\alpha_1^2 < 1$, i.e. the strictly tighter $\alpha_1^2 < 1/3$. As $\alpha_1^2 \uparrow 1/3$ the kurtosis $\rightarrow \infty$.

(c) With $\alpha_0 = 4 \times 10^{-4}$, $\alpha_1 = 0.5$ and $r_t = 0.04$ (so $r_t^2 = 1.6 \times 10^{-3}$),

$$\sigma_{t+1}^2 = \alpha_0 + \alpha_1 r_t^2 = 4 \times 10^{-4} + 0.5 (1.6 \times 10^{-3}) = 4 \times 10^{-4} + 8 \times 10^{-4} = 1.2 \times 10^{-3},$$

so $\sigma_{t+1} = \sqrt{1.2 \times 10^{-3}} \approx 0.0346$. Since $r_{t+1} \mid \mathcal{F}_t \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma_{t+1}^2)$, the 95% conditional predictive interval is

$$0 \pm 1.96 \sigma_{t+1} = \pm 1.96 (0.0346) \approx \pm 0.0679.$$

The unconditional variance is $\text{Var}(r_t) = \alpha_0/(1 - \alpha_1) = 4 \times 10^{-4}/0.5 = 8 \times 10^{-4}$, so $\sqrt{\text{Var}(r_t)} \approx 0.0283$ and the unconditional band is $\pm 1.96 (0.0283) \approx \pm 0.0554$. The conditional band (± 0.068) is markedly *wider* than the unconditional one (± 0.055): after the large move $r_t = 0.04$ the model raises its volatility forecast — exactly the volatility-clustering behaviour ARCH is designed to capture.

Problem 4 (5 points)

Statement.

(Revision of Week 11: diagnostics — Ljung–Box test and AIC/BIC selection.) A mean-zero ARMA(1, 1) model is fitted to $n = 100$ observations. The residual sample autocorrelations at lags 1–5 are

$$\hat{r}_1 = 0.05, \quad \hat{r}_2 = -0.12, \quad \hat{r}_3 = 0.08, \quad \hat{r}_4 = -0.10, \quad \hat{r}_5 = 0.06.$$

Recall the Ljung–Box statistic $Q_m = n(n+2) \sum_{\tau=1}^m \hat{r}_\tau^2 / (n-\tau)$, which under $H_0 : \rho_1 = \dots = \rho_m = 0$ is approximately χ_{m-p-q}^2 for an ARMA(p, q) fit. Useful quantiles: $\chi_{2,0.95}^2 = 5.991$, $\chi_{3,0.95}^2 = 7.815$, $\chi_{4,0.95}^2 = 9.488$.

(a) Compute the Ljung–Box statistic Q_5 (show the per-lag terms). (1.5 pts)

(b) Test $H_0 : \rho_1 = \dots = \rho_5 = 0$ at the 5% level: state the degrees of freedom, the critical value, the decision, and the practical conclusion about model adequacy. Would the decision change had an AR(1) been fitted instead? (1.5 pts)

(c) Recall $\text{AIC} = -2 \log L + 2k$ and $\text{BIC} = -2 \log L + k \log n$ with $k = p + q + 1$ for an ARMA(p, q). A competing AR(3) (i.e. $k = 4$) is compared with the ARMA(1, 1) (i.e. $k = 3$) at $n = 100$. By how much must $-2 \log L$ drop for AIC, respectively BIC, to prefer the larger model, and which criterion is more willing to select it? Why is in-sample R^2 a poor tool for this comparison? (2 pts)

Solution.

(a) With $n = 100$, $n(n+2) = 100 \cdot 102 = 10200$, and $m = 5$:

$$Q_5 = 10200 \left(\frac{0.05^2}{99} + \frac{(-0.12)^2}{98} + \frac{0.08^2}{97} + \frac{(-0.10)^2}{96} + \frac{0.06^2}{95} \right).$$

Term by term,

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{0.0025}{99} &= 2.525 \times 10^{-5}, & \frac{0.0144}{98} &= 1.469 \times 10^{-4}, & \frac{0.0064}{97} &= 6.598 \times 10^{-5}, \\ \frac{0.0100}{96} &= 1.042 \times 10^{-4}, & \frac{0.0036}{95} &= 3.789 \times 10^{-5}. \end{aligned}$$

Summing the five terms gives 3.802×10^{-4} , so

$$Q_5 \approx 10200 \times 3.802 \times 10^{-4} \approx \boxed{3.88}.$$

(b) For an ARMA(1, 1), $p = q = 1$, so $\text{df} = m - p - q = 5 - 1 - 1 = 3$. The 5% critical value is $\chi_{3,0.95}^2 = 7.815$. Since $Q_5 \approx 3.88 < 7.815$, we **do not reject** H_0 : there is no significant evidence of residual autocorrelation up to lag 5, so the ARMA(1, 1) appears *adequate*.

Had an AR(1) been fitted, $p = 1, q = 0$, so $\text{df} = 5 - 1 - 0 = 4$ and the critical value rises to $\chi_{4,0.95}^2 = 9.488$. Since $3.88 < 9.488$, the decision is unchanged (do not reject). In general fewer fitted parameters leave more degrees of freedom and widen the acceptance region.

(c) The parameter counts are $k = p + q + 1$: for ARMA(1, 1), $k = 3$; for AR(3), $k = 4$ (one extra parameter). With $n = 100$, $\log n = \log 100 \approx 4.605$. Comparing penalties when adding the one extra parameter:

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta(\text{penalty})_{\text{AIC}} &= 2(k_{\text{big}} - k_{\text{small}}) = 2, \\ \Delta(\text{penalty})_{\text{BIC}} &= (\log n)(k_{\text{big}} - k_{\text{small}}) = \log 100 \approx 4.605. \end{aligned}$$

So the AR(3) is preferred only if $-2 \log L$ drops by more than the extra penalty:

AIC: drop > 2 (i.e. $\log L$ improves by > 1); BIC: drop > 4.605 ($\log L$ improves by > 2.30).

Since BIC's $\log n = 4.605 > 2$ charges more per parameter (as $n > e^2 \approx 7.4$), **AIC is more willing to select the larger AR(3) model**; BIC is harder to satisfy and favours the parsimonious ARMA(1, 1).

In-sample $R^2 = 1 - s_e^2/s_y^2$ is a poor selection tool because adding parameters can only *increase* it (the larger nested model fits the training data at least as well), so a higher R^2 for AR(3) is no evidence of a genuinely better model; moreover even the true model has a bounded R^2 (a stochastic process is not perfectly predictable). Information criteria penalise complexity and are the correct basis for the comparison.